



South America

Most of the continent of South America lies south of the equator. Its different climates and habitats mean it is home to many unique animal species.

GALAPAGOS ISLANDS

The 19 islands of the Galápagos were formed by volcanoes on the ocean floor. They are now strictly controlled to protect the many animal and bird species that live on them.



GIANT TORTOISE

These huge reptiles can weigh as much as 300 kg (660 lb) and grow up to 1.2 m (4 ft) in length.



LAND IGUANA

The Galápagos land iguana may look ferocious, but it is actually a herbivore.

ANGEL FALLS

Angel Falls is the world's highest uninterrupted waterfall at 979 m (3,212 ft). The falls lie on the Gauja River, in the Canaima National Park in Venezuela. The indigenous name for the falls is *Kerepakupai Vená*, which means "waterfalls of the deepest place".



BEAUTY SPOT
Angel Falls is one of Venezuela's top tourist attractions.



FRIGATEBIRD

Male frigatebirds have impressive red throat pouches, which they inflate to attract females.

FAST FACTS

Most of the population of South America live around the coast. The wild inland areas are sparsely populated.

AREA:

17,819,000 sq km (6,879,000 sq miles)

POPULATION:

389,860,000

NUMBER OF COUNTRIES:

12 independent countries
3 dependent territories

LARGEST COUNTRY:

Brazil 8,511,965 sq km
(3,286,469 sq miles)

LARGEST COUNTRY BY POPULATION:

Brazil 195,632,000

LARGEST CITY BY POPULATION:

São Paulo, Brazil 11,821,873

HIGHEST POINT:

Cerro Aconcagua, Andes Mountains,
Argentina 6,959 m (22,833 ft)

LONGEST RIVER:

Amazon 6,439 km (4,001 miles)

LARGEST LAKE:

Lake Titicaca, Bolivia/Peru
8,340 sq km (3,220 sq miles)

